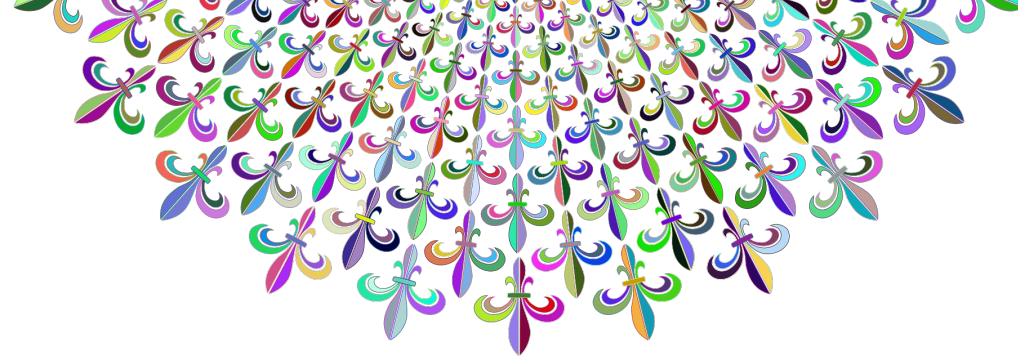




NewsImages 2026

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Luca Rossetto, Dublin City University

Ali A. Katamjani, Utrecht University,

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MediaEval Workshop
15-16 June 2026,
Amsterdam, Netherlands
and Online



Bilston school takes trip down memory lane as staff and pupils celebrate 90th anniversary.



Background and Motivation

- Images drive engagements with news
- Headline-image relation not necessarily literal
- Large design space for recommending images
- Rapid progress in retrieval and generative models



Data

- 15,000+ news headlines with images
- Sourced from the web (GDELT/MIND) and print
 - Title: “Global stocks, dollar gain as UK ...”
 - Article (URL): <https://www.marketscreener.com/...>
 - Image: original or scan (only for training)



Approaches

- SOTA VLM-based generative approaches
- Hybrid approaches based on category
- Exploration of art styles and subjects



Evaluation and Metrics

- Online evaluation with experts & non-experts
- 5-point Likert scale to rate headline-image fit
- Evaluation criterion is average fit for a run



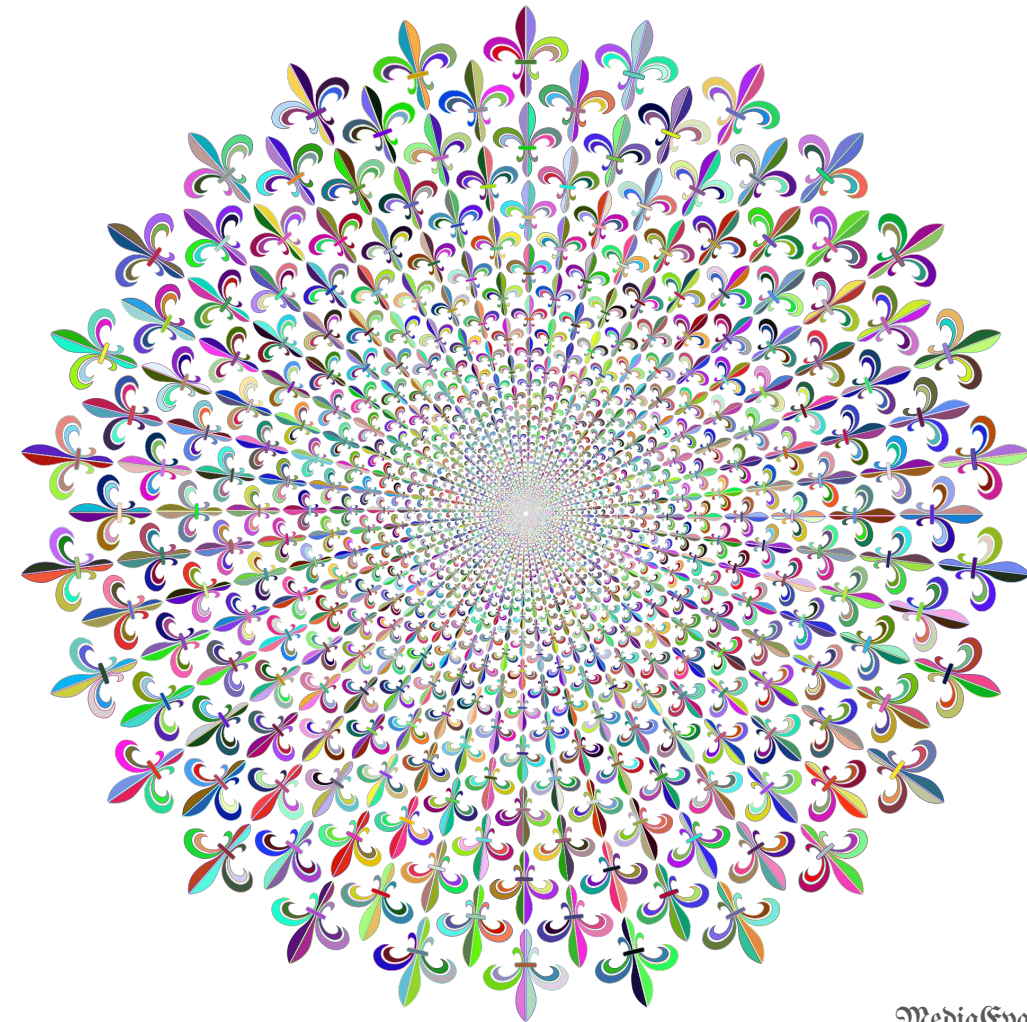
Leaderboard

TEAM	APPROACH	SCORE
CERTH-ITI	Run 6	3.616
FAST-MS	RealVisXL	3.209
TEAM-A++	SDXL-CFT	3.041
NewsWeavers	Qwen 3B Plan Prompt Zero Shot FLUX	2.907
Originals	Editorial Baseline	2.880

Results

- Automated approaches can outperform editors
- Personal preferences matter, no “right” answer
- Human oversight and quality control





Questions?